

Emma Watson: Profile

Early Life and Family

Emma Charlotte Duerre Watson was born on 15 April 1990 in Paris, France. Her parents, Jacqueline Luesby and Chris Watson, are both British lawyers. When Emma was about five years old, her parents separated and she moved with her mother and younger brother Alex to Oxfordshire, England. She also has half-siblings on her father's side.

Schooling and Acting Training

Emma attended the Dragon School in Oxford and later Headington School. From a young age she trained in acting, singing and dancing at the Oxford branch of Stagecoach Theatre Arts, and she performed in school plays.

Harry Potter Role

Emma was cast as Hermione Granger at the age of nine after several rounds of auditions. She played the character in all eight Harry Potter films, from Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone in 2001 to Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows Part 2 in 2011. In January 2022 she returned for the HBO Max reunion special Return to Hogwarts.

Other Film Work

After Harry Potter, Emma appeared in My Week with Marilyn (2011), The Perks of Being a Wallflower (2012), The Bling Ring (2013), Noah (2014), Regression (2015) and Colonia (2015). She played Belle in Disney's live-action Beauty and the Beast (2017), starred in The Circle (2017), and played Meg March in Greta Gerwig's Little Women (2019). Earlier, she voiced a character in The Tale of Despereaux (2008) and appeared in the TV film Ballet Shoes (2007).

Education

Emma studied English literature at Brown University in the United States and graduated with a bachelor's degree in 2014. During 2012 and 2013 she spent a year at Worcester College, Oxford, as a visiting student.

UN Women and HeForShe

In July 2014 Emma was appointed a Goodwill Ambassador for UN Women. In September 2014 she gave a widely covered speech at the United Nations headquarters in New York to launch the HeForShe campaign, which invites men and boys to support gender equality.

Activism and Philanthropy

In January 2016 Emma started Our Shared Shelf, an online feminist book club hosted on Goodreads. In 2017 she took part in a Book Fairies project, leaving books in public places in cities such as Paris and London for strangers to find. In 2018 she donated one million pounds to the Time's Up UK Justice and Equality Fund, which supports people facing sexual harassment in the workplace.

Sustainable Fashion

Emma is a prominent advocate for sustainable and ethical fashion. She has worked with the label People Tree, and at the 2016 Met Gala she wore a Calvin Klein gown made partly from recycled plastic bottles. In 2019 she joined the board of directors of the luxury group Kering. She also co-founded Renais, a sustainable gin brand, with her brother Alex Watson, launched in 2022.

Modelling and Brand Work

Emma was the face of Burberry's campaigns in 2009 and 2010, and in 2011 she became an ambassador for the beauty brand Lancôme.

Awards and Recognition

In 2018 Emma won the first gender-neutral MTV Movie and TV Award for Best Actor in a Movie for her role as Belle in *Beauty and the Beast*. She was named to the TIME 100 list of influential people in 2015.

Break from Acting

After *Little Women* in 2019, Emma stepped back from acting to focus on other interests. In a 2019 interview with *British Vogue* she described herself as being self-partnered.

Sample Test Questions for a RAG System

1. Where and when was Emma Watson born? 2. Which character did she play in the Harry Potter films? 3. What did she study at Brown University and when did she graduate? 4. What is HeForShe and when did she launch it? 5. Which film did she win the first gender-neutral MTV award for? 6. Which company's board did she join in 2019? 7. What is Our Shared Shelf? 8. Who did she co-found Renais with?